

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 480

By Rudd

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Coordinator of Elections Mark Goins for his ongoing service to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of the members of this General Assembly to specially recognize those outstanding public servants who have devoted their careers to serving the citizens of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable individual is Mark Goins, Coordinator of Elections with the Secretary of State's Office, who has distinguished himself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Goins was appointed by Secretary of State Tre Hargett as the Coordinator of Elections on February 11, 2009; during his distinguished tenure, Mr. Goins has worked with the General Assembly to implement laws to ensure fair, secure, and free elections, including requiring a photo ID, robust voting machine vendor ethics regulations, and anti-election hacking laws; and

WHEREAS, Mark Goins also oversaw the rollout of the successful GoVoteTN voter app, online voter registration, and the "I'm Registered to Vote. Are You?" campaign to encourage voter registration; and

WHEREAS, under Secretary Hargett's and Coordinator Goins's leadership, the State of Tennessee has been ranked No. 1 in election integrity for three consecutive years, and in 2023, the Secretary of State's Office was awarded a national honor by the U.S. Election Assistance Commission for piloting videos in American Sign Language for Constitutional Amendments; and

WHEREAS, a trusted and admired leader in his field, Mark Goins was selected by his peers to chair the United States Election Assistance Commission (EAC) Standards Board in

2016; the 110-member EAC is an independent group of state and local election officials created by the Help America Vote Act (HAVA) of 2002 to assist states in being HAVA compliant; and

WHEREAS, he has also been tapped to serve on the Elections Infrastructure Government Coordinating Council and the National Association for State Election Directors, which he has served as treasurer and secretary and currently serves as vice president; and

WHEREAS, he is frequently sought out to give presentations on disaster preparedness, after Tennessee successfully conducted an election the morning after a deadly tornado ripped through parts of the State; and

WHEREAS, prior to being appointed Coordinator of Elections, Mark Goins served on the State Election Commission from March 2005 to February 2009; and

WHEREAS, from 1996 to 2002, he represented District 34 in the Tennessee House of Representatives, during which time he served on the Elections Subcommittee and was selected as the 2002 East Tennessee Development District Legislator of the Year; and

WHEREAS, a native of Campbell County, Mr. Goins received his Bachelor of Arts degree in History from Lincoln Memorial University and his Doctor of Jurisprudence from Regent University School of Law; he also studied comparative law at Oxford University in England; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of his distinguished professional career and faithful public service, Lincoln Memorial University inducted him into its Professional Hall of Fame in 2018; and

WHEREAS, Mark Goins is an inspiration to his colleagues, and his friendship and counsel are highly valued by those who are fortunate to know him; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Goins epitomizes the ideal of the dedicated professional who is wholly committed to the highest tenets of public service, and he is most worthy of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Mark Goins for his many years of devoted service as Coordinator of Elections with the Secretary of State's Office, extending our gratitude for his steadfast integrity and invaluable leadership.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.